

DIFFICULT

1. Passage anchor

> “She spoke in a calm, confident way, and she had this rare ability to make **difficult ideas** sound much less frightening.”

Passage meaning

difficult = hard to understand, deal with, solve, or do

困難的；**難懂的**；**難處理的**

Here:

> **difficult ideas**

= **難懂的概念**；**複雜而不容易理解的想法**

Practice

1. She could explain **difficult concepts** in a simple way.

她能用簡單的方法解釋**難懂的概念**。

2. Physics felt less **difficult** once I understood the basic principles.

當我理解基本原理後，物理就沒有那麼**難**了。

Core meanings of DIFFICULT

2. difficult — hard to do

= requiring a lot of effort, skill, thought, or determination

困難的；**難做的**

Examples

1. This task is quite **difficult**.

這項任務相當**困難**。

2. It was **difficult to finish** everything on time.

要準時完成所有事情很**困難**。

This is the central general meaning.

3. difficult to understand

= hard to understand because something is complex, unclear, or unfamiliar

****難懂的；難理解的****

This is the exact passage branch.

Examples

1. The theory is ****difficult to understand**** at first.

這個理論一開始很****難理解****。

2. She made a ****difficult idea**** sound simple.

她把一個****難懂的概念****講得很簡單。

4. difficult question / problem

= hard to answer, solve, or deal with

****困難的問題；難題****

Examples

1. The teacher asked a ****difficult question****.

老師問了一個****很難的問題****。

2. We are trying to solve a ****difficult problem****.

我們正試著解決一個****難題****。

Difficult situations

5. difficult situation

= a situation that is hard to manage or deal with

****困難局面；棘手情況****

Examples

1. She remained calm in a ****difficult situation****.

她在****困難情況****下仍保持冷靜。

2. The manager had to deal with a ****difficult situation****.

經理必須處理一個**棘手局面**。

6. difficult decision / choice

= a decision that is hard to make

艱難的決定；難以抉擇的選擇

Examples

1. Leaving the job was a **difficult decision**.

離開那份工作是一個**艱難的決定**。

2. She faced a **difficult choice**.

她面臨一個**難以抉擇的選擇**。

People

7. difficult person

= someone who is hard to deal with because of their behavior, attitude, or personality

難相處的人；難應付的人

Examples

1. He can be a **difficult person** to work with.

他可能是一個很**難合作的人**。

2. She remained patient with a **difficult customer**.

她面對一位**難應付的顧客**時仍保持耐心。

This is a major distinct use.

8. difficult child / student / customer

= someone whose behavior is hard to manage

難管教的孩子 / 難帶的學生 / 難應付的顧客

Examples

1. The teacher knew how to handle **difficult students**.

那位老師懂得如何應付**難帶的學生**。

2. Staff are trained to deal with **difficult customers**.

員工接受訓練，學習如何應對**難纏的顧客**。

Behavior / personality

9. difficult behavior

= behavior that causes problems or is hard to manage

難處理的行為；棘手行為

Examples

1. The child's **difficult behavior** improved over time.

那個孩子的**難處理行為**逐漸改善。

2. Teachers sometimes need strategies for managing **difficult behavior**.

老師有時需要處理**棘手行為**的策略。

Time / period

10. difficult time / period

= a period involving hardship, stress, or problems

艱難時期；困難時期

Examples

1. She supported me through a **difficult time**.

她陪我度過了一段**艱難時期**。

2. The company went through a **difficult period**.

公司經歷了一段**困難時期**。

Conditions / circumstances

11. difficult conditions

= circumstances that make something hard to do or endure

****艱難條件；惡劣環境****

Examples

1. They worked under ****difficult conditions****.
他們在****艱難條件****下工作。
2. The rescue team continued despite ****difficult conditions****.
儘管環境****艱難****，救援隊仍繼續行動。

Hard to achieve

12. difficult goal / task

= something requiring significant effort or ability to achieve

****難達成的目標；艱難任務****

Examples

1. It was a ****difficult goal**** but not impossible.
那是一個****難以達成的目標****，但並非不可能。
2. Explaining the theory clearly was a ****difficult task****.
把這個理論清楚解釋是一項****艱難任務****。

Hard to obtain / access

13. difficult to get / find / reach

= hard to obtain, locate, or access

****難取得；難找到；難到達****

Examples

1. Tickets were ****difficult to get****.
票很****難買到****。
2. The village is ****difficult to reach**** in winter.
冬天那個村莊很****難到達****。

Hard to explain / describe

14. difficult to explain / describe

= hard to put into words clearly

難以解釋；難以形容

Examples

1. The feeling is **difficult to describe**.

這種感覺很**難形容**。

2. The result is **difficult to explain**.

這個結果很**難解釋**。

Emotionally hard

15. difficult — emotionally painful or uncomfortable

= hard because it causes emotional stress, sadness, or discomfort

艱難的；令人難受的

Examples

1. It was a **difficult conversation**.

那是一場**很艱難的談話**。

2. Saying goodbye was **difficult**.

道別是一件**很難受的事**。

Formal pattern: make something difficult

16. make something difficult

= cause something to become harder to do, understand, or manage

使……變得困難

Examples

1. Poor communication **made the situation difficult**.

溝通不良**讓情況變得更難處理**。

2. Lack of sleep ****makes concentration difficult****.

睡眠不足會****讓專注變得困難****。

Impersonal pattern

17. it is difficult to...

= doing something is hard

****做某事很困難****

Examples

1. It is ****difficult to remain calm under pressure****.

在壓力下保持冷靜很****困難****。

2. It is ****difficult to explain the idea without an example****.

沒有例子時，要解釋這個概念很****困難****。

Difficult for someone

18. difficult for someone

= hard for a particular person to do, understand, or manage

****對某人來說很困難****

Examples

1. Physics was ****difficult for me**** at first.

物理一開始****對我來說很難****。

2. Public speaking is ****difficult for some students****.

公開演講****對有些學生來說很困難****。

Difficult + noun

19. difficult issue

= complicated or sensitive matter that is hard to resolve or discuss

****棘手議題；難題****

Examples

1. The meeting dealt with several ****difficult issues****.
會議處理了幾個****棘手議題****。
2. This is a ****difficult issue**** with no simple answer.
這是一個沒有簡單答案的****難題****。

20. difficult relationship

= relationship involving tension, conflict, or problems
****難相處的關係；複雜關係****

Examples

1. They had a ****difficult relationship**** for years.
他們多年來的關係一直很****複雜 / 不容易相處****。
2. She had a ****difficult relationship**** with her manager.
她和主管的關係很****難處理****。

Related forms

21. difficulty

A. trouble or effort required to do something

****困難；難度****

1. I had ****difficulty understanding the explanation****.
我****很難理解那個解釋****。
2. She completed the task without ****difficulty****.
她毫無****困難****地完成了任務。

B. a particular problem

****困難；問題****

1. We encountered several ****difficulties****.
我們遇到幾個****困難****。

2. Technical ****difficulties**** delayed the presentation.

****技術問題****延誤了簡報。

22. have difficulty doing something

= find something hard to do

****做某事有困難****

Examples

1. I had ****difficulty following the explanation****.

我****很難**跟上那個解釋******。

2. Some students have ****difficulty speaking in public****.

有些學生****很難**在公開場合說話******。

Very important pattern.

23. with difficulty

= only by making a lot of effort

****艱難地；費力地****

Examples

1. He stood up ****with difficulty****.

他****費力地****站起來。

2. She completed the climb ****with difficulty****.

她****很艱難地****完成了攀登。

24. without difficulty

= easily; without encountering problems

****毫無困難地；順利地****

Examples

1. She solved the problem ****without difficulty****.

她****毫不費力地****解決了問題。

2. We found the building ****without difficulty****.

我們****很順利地****找到了那棟建築。

Comparative and superlative

25. more difficult / most difficult

Examples

1. This chapter is ****more difficult**** than the last one.

這一章比上一章****更難****。

2. That was the ****most difficult**** part of the exam.

那是考試中****最困難的部分****。

Key contrasts

26. difficult vs hard

****difficult****

= hard to do, understand, manage, etc.

****困難的****

****hard****

can mean the same thing, but also has many unrelated meanings such as:

* not soft

* with great effort

* severely

Compare:

> a ****difficult problem****

> 一個困難問題

> a ****hard problem****

> 一個難題

Both are natural.

****Difficult**** is often slightly more formal.

27. difficult vs complicated

****difficult****

= hard to do or understand

****complicated****

= containing many connected parts, details, or factors

****複雜的****

Something can be complicated without being difficult, or difficult without being complicated.

Compare:

> The instructions are ****complicated****.

> 說明很複雜。

> The task is ****difficult****.

> 任務很難。

28. difficult vs complex

****complex****

= consisting of many interconnected parts or ideas

****複雜的****

****difficult****

= hard for someone to understand or do

****困難的****

A complex idea often becomes difficult, but they are not identical.

29. difficult vs challenging

****challenging****

= requiring effort and skill, often with a positive sense of worthwhile difficulty

****具挑戰性的****

****difficult****

= neutral statement that something is hard

Compare:

> The assignment was **difficult**.

> 作業很難。

> The assignment was **challenging but rewarding**.

> 作業很有挑戰性，但很值得。

30. difficult vs tough

tough

= informal; difficult, demanding, or harsh

艱難的；棘手的

Compare:

> a **difficult exam**

> 很難的考試

> a **tough exam**

> 很難 / 很硬的考試

Tough is more conversational.

31. difficult vs troublesome

troublesome

= causing repeated inconvenience or problems

麻煩的；棘手的

difficult

= broader

A difficult person can be hard to deal with; a troublesome person may actively cause problems.

32. difficult vs impossible

difficult

= hard but potentially achievable

****困難的****

****impossible****

= cannot be done

****不可能的****

Compare:

> It is ****difficult****, but possible.

> 很難，但做得到。

> It is ****impossible****.

> 不可能做到。

Meaning map

The central concept of ****difficult**** is:

****requiring substantial effort, skill, thought, or emotional strength****

From this develop:

Task

difficult task

→ ****難做****

Understanding

difficult idea

→ ****難懂****

Problem

difficult question

→ ****難解決****

Situation

difficult situation

→ ****難處理****

Person

difficult person

→ ****難相處 / 難應付****

Period

difficult time

→ ****艱難時期****

Emotion

difficult conversation

→ ****令人難受 / 難以面對****

The passage uses the understanding branch:

****the ideas are conceptually hard to understand****

MCQ-ready master list

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
-----	-----
difficult — general	需要很多努力、技巧、思考或耐力才能完成；困難的
difficult to understand	因內容複雜、不熟悉或不清楚而難以理解
difficult idea/concept	不容易理解或掌握的想法 / 概念
difficult question/problem	不容易回答、解決或處理的問題
difficult situation	很難管理、處理或應對的情況
difficult decision/choice	很難作出取捨或判斷的決定
difficult person	因態度、行為或個性而難以相處 / 應付的人
difficult student/customer	行為或需求較難管理、應對的人
difficult behavior	很難管理或造成麻煩的行為
difficult time/period	充滿壓力、問題或痛苦的艱難時期
difficult conditions	令工作或生活更難進行的艱難 / 惡劣條件
difficult to get/find/reach	很難取得、找到或到達
difficult to explain/describe	很難清楚表達、解釋或形容
difficult — emotionally hard	因令人痛苦、尷尬或有壓力而難以面對
difficult for someone	對某個特定的人來說不容易
difficulty — trouble/effort	做某事時遇到的困難或所需的額外努力
difficulty — problem	阻礙事情順利進行的具體問題
have difficulty doing	覺得做某事很困難
with difficulty	花很大努力、費力地完成
without difficulty	沒有遇到問題；輕鬆 / 順利地完成

Passage recap

> “...she had this rare ability to make **difficult ideas** sound much less frightening.”

Here:

difficult = **hard to understand**

Best Traditional Chinese:

* **難懂的** *

* **難理解的** *

* **複雜的** (視語境)

* contextually: **原本很難理解的概念**

Natural contextual translation:

她有一種很難得的能力，就是能把原本難懂的概念講得沒那麼可怕。

Passage MCQ-ready meaning

difficult in **“difficult ideas”**

= **hard to understand or mentally process**

難懂的；難理解的

The key distinction is:

> **difficult idea**

> → **難理解的概念**

versus:

> **difficult person**

> → **難相處 / 難應付的人**

and:

> **difficult time**

> → **艱難時期**

The common core is **“hard to deal with in some way,”** but the exact Traditional Chinese meaning changes with the object.